

AI Python for Beginners

Based on Andrew Ng @deeplearning.ai 2026

Source

- Andrew Ng, AI Python for Beginners, deeplearning.ai (2026).
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Get Colab Pro

As a student you have access to Colab Pro: register here colab.research.google.com/signup

Why AI Python for Beginners

- Why AI?

The capabilities of generative AI to write code are outstanding. These capabilities come from deep learning AI, AI that is based on very large neural network type applications.

- Why Python?

Python is a general-purpose language and the most used language in deep learning applications. Even if the underlying code is written in C/C++, Python is the most likely, most versatile wrapper language for production purposes. Helpful user community, many resources.

Python is everywhere in AI: Self-driving cars, chatbots, smart agriculture, video games, web pages, are often wrapped in Python.

- Why AI Python?

Add the capability to write code well (enough) in an important language like Python that is good (enough) to do most jobs, then you need the skill to generate, and understand Python code by AI. This is the currently most meaningful definition of "AI literacy", just like "digital literacy" is the ability to understand digital devices.

How Chatbots interact with Python (Demo)

Load this Colab starter code, then save a copy in Drive. tinyurl.com/ai-python-ipynb

- Prompt 0: <https://tinyurl.com/gemini-instructions>

System Instruction: From now on, follow these formatting rules for all responses:

- For Headlines/Text: Provide only the raw Markdown (e.g., # Headline or regular text). Do NOT include my prompt or any introductory filler like "Here is your headline."
- For Code/Modifications: Always include my original prompt in a comment or a text block immediately above the code block.

- Placement: Always assume I want these responses to be appended to the end of the notebook.
 - Interaction: Use the "Add to Notebook" format so I can click one button to place it at the bottom.
 - Whenever you need to restart the chat, enter `Clear chat` at the prompt.
 - Prompt 1:

Generate a new headline ``The first Python program``.
 - Prompt:

Which program is traditionally written first by new programmers?
 - Prompt:

Modify the code to say hello to me, not to the whole world. My name is Marcus.
 - Prompt:

Add another section called ``Calculating something``.
 - Prompt:

Write some code that computes how many days there are between the fourth of July and my birthday (Dec 29).
 - Prompt:

In the notebook, explain each line of this program to me briefly, as if I had never written a line of Python.
 - Prompt:

Tell me what I should build next to learn more Python.
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Home assignment

Build a traceable learning workflow using AI + Python.

1. Complete this AI Python lesson by building a "guess the number" game.
2. Ask the AI about things you don't understand, until you understand them well enough to explain them yourself.
3. Make sure that your prompts and the responses appear in the submitted notebook.
4. Make sure the notebook is shared with Lyon College.
5. Submit the notebook URL to Canvas.

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